

FA 5 - LINEAR MODELS: Palmer Penguins Dataset

2026-10-08

Research Question: #Does penguin body mass differ according to species and sex, and does the effect of species on body mass depend on sex? #Factor 1: Species – Adelie, Chinstrap, Gentoo #Factor 2: Sex – Female, Male #Response Variable: Body Mass (body mass g)

#Part A/1

```
# a. & b. Download and Import the dataset directly from the official URL
url <- "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/allisonhorst/palmerpenguins/main/inst/extdata/penguins.csv"
penguins <- read.csv(url)
```

```
# c. Examine the structure of the dataset
str(penguins)
```

```
## 'data.frame': 344 obs. of 8 variables:
## $ species      : chr "Adelie" "Adelie" "Adelie" "Adelie" ...
## $ island       : chr "Torgersen" "Torgersen" "Torgersen" "Torgersen" ...
## $ bill_length_mm : num 39.1 39.5 40.3 NA 36.7 39.3 38.9 39.2 34.1 42 ...
## $ bill_depth_mm : num 18.7 17.4 18 NA 19.3 20.6 17.8 19.6 18.1 20.2 ...
## $ flipper_length_mm: int 181 186 195 NA 193 190 181 195 193 190 ...
## $ body_mass_g   : int 3750 3800 3250 NA 3450 3650 3625 4675 3475 4250 ...
## $ sex          : chr "male" "female" "female" NA ...
## $ year         : int 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 2007 ...
```

```
# d. Identify missing observations
summary(penguins)
```

```
##      species      island      bill_length_mm  bill_depth_mm
## Length:344      Length:344      Min.   :32.10    Min.   :13.10
## Class :character Class :character 1st Qu.:39.23    1st Qu.:15.60
## Mode  :character Mode  :character Median :44.45    Median :17.30
##                                     Mean  :43.92    Mean  :17.15
##                                     3rd Qu.:48.50    3rd Qu.:18.70
##                                     Max.   :59.60    Max.   :21.50
##                                     NA's   :2       NA's   :2
## flipper_length_mm  body_mass_g      sex      year
## Min.   :172.0      Min.   :2700    Length:344    Min.   :2007
## 1st Qu.:190.0      1st Qu.:3550    Class :character 1st Qu.:2007
## Median :197.0      Median :4050    Mode  :character Median :2008
## Mean   :200.9      Mean   :4202                      Mean   :2008
## 3rd Qu.:213.0      3rd Qu.:4750                      3rd Qu.:2009
## Max.   :231.0      Max.   :6300                      Max.   :2009
## NA's    :2         NA's    :2
```

```
# e. Remove observations with missing values in body_mass_g, species, and sex
penguins_clean <- subset(
  penguins,
  !is.na(body_mass_g) &
```

```

!is.na(species) &
!is.na(sex)
)

# f. Convert species and sex into appropriate categorical/factor variables
penguins_clean$species <- factor(penguins_clean$species)
penguins_clean$sex <- factor(penguins_clean$sex)

# g. Report the final sample size used in your analysis
nrow(penguins_clean)

```

```
## [1] 333
```

```
#Part B/2
```

```
# 5.1 Descriptive Statistics
```

```
cat("=== Overall Descriptive Statistics ===\n")
```

```
## === Overall Descriptive Statistics ===
```

```
summary(penguins_clean$body_mass_g)
```

```
##      Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.
##      2700   3550   4050   4207   4775   6300
```

```
cat("\n=== Mean Body Mass by Species ===\n")
```

```
##
```

```
## === Mean Body Mass by Species ===
```

```
aggregate(body_mass_g ~ species, data = penguins_clean, FUN = mean)
```

```
##      species body_mass_g
## 1    Adelie   3706.164
## 2 Chinstrap   3733.088
## 3    Gentoo   5092.437
```

```
cat("\n=== Mean Body Mass by Sex ===\n")
```

```
##
```

```
## === Mean Body Mass by Sex ===
```

```
aggregate(body_mass_g ~ sex, data = penguins_clean, FUN = mean)
```

```
##      sex body_mass_g
## 1 female   3862.273
## 2   male   4545.685
```

```
cat("\n=== Mean Body Mass by Species and Sex ===\n")
```

```
##
```

```
## === Mean Body Mass by Species and Sex ===
```

```
aggregate(body_mass_g ~ species + sex, data = penguins_clean, FUN = mean)
```

```
##      species    sex body_mass_g
## 1    Adelie female   3368.836
## 2 Chinstrap female   3527.206
## 3    Gentoo female   4679.741
## 4    Adelie   male   4043.493
```

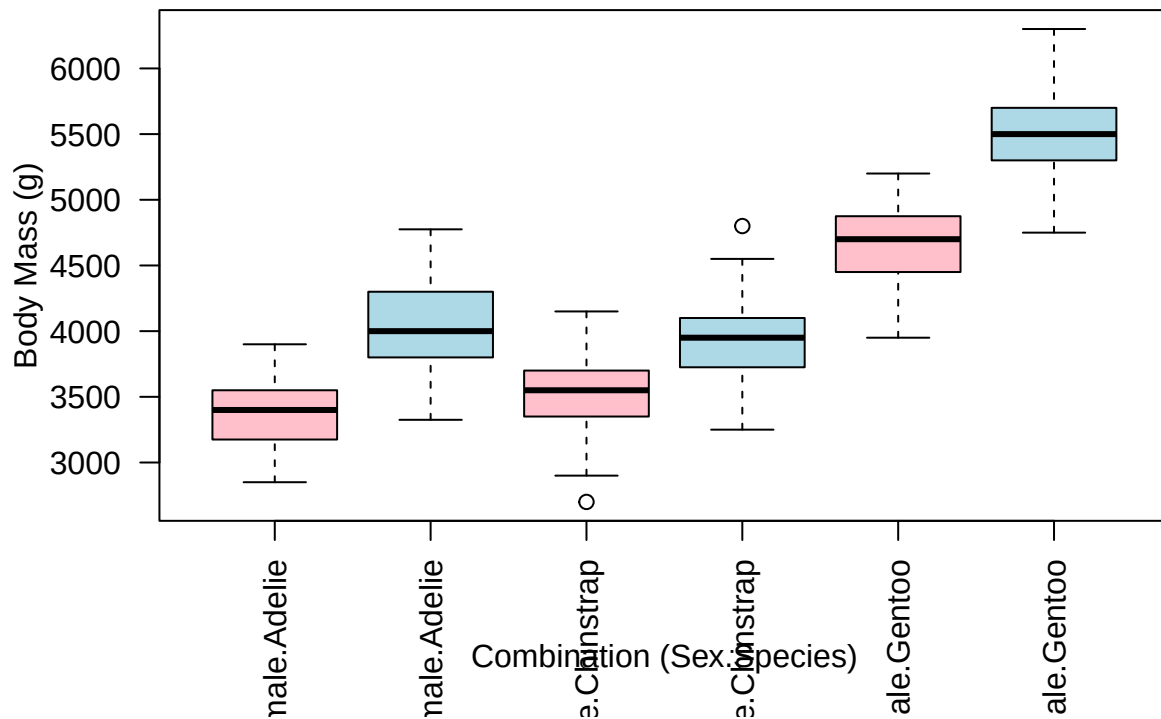
```
## 5 Chinstrap    male    3938.971
## 6    Gentoo    male    5484.836
```

5.2 Visualization

Using base R boxplot to completely bypass any library issues or syntax clashes

```
boxplot(body_mass_g ~ sex * species,
        data = penguins_clean,
        col = c("pink", "lightblue"),
        main = "Distribution of Penguin Body Mass by Species and Sex",
        xlab = "Combination (Sex.Species)",
        ylab = "Body Mass (g)",
        las = 2)
```

Distribution of Penguin Body Mass by Species and Sex



#5.3 Pattern Description #*Comparing Species about highest body mass: Taking a look at the data, the one with the highest body mass is the Gentoo species both male and female, which the male has 5484.836g, and the female has 4,679.741g.

#*The sex that appears to have a higher body mass Reading from the data, across all species, males have higher body mass than females.

#*The differences males and females appearance whether they'd be similar or not across species There's nothing similar here and the differences vary: -Gentoo has the largest gap (~805 g difference) -Adelie has a moderate gap (~675 g difference) -Chinstrap has the smallest gap (~412 g difference)

#Part C/3 #a Null hypothesis:The true mean body mass is equal across all three penguin species

#b Alternative hypothesis:At least one penguin species has a true mean body mass that is different from the others

#*c&d

```

# Fit the One-Way ANOVA model
oneway_model <- aov(body_mass_g ~ species, data = penguins_clean)

# Display the ANOVA table, F-statistic, degrees of freedom, and p-value
summary(oneway_model)

##              Df      Sum Sq Mean Sq F value Pr(>F)
## species        2 145190219 72595110   341.9 <2e-16 ***
## Residuals     330  70069447   212332
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

#e Reject the null hypothesis due to the p-value significantly smaller than the standard significance threshold
a=0.05

#f What this means is that there's an overwhelming significant different across different species about the
body mass or the penguin's weight.

#Part D/4

# Fit the equivalent dummy-variable regression model
dummy_model <- lm(body_mass_g ~ species, data = penguins_clean)

# Display the regression coefficients, R-squared, and F-statistic
summary(dummy_model)

##
## Call:
## lm(formula = body_mass_g ~ species, data = penguins_clean)
##
## Residuals:
##      Min       1Q   Median       3Q      Max
## -1142.44  -342.44   -33.09   307.56  1207.56
##
## Coefficients:
##              Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
## (Intercept)    3706.16     38.14   97.184 <2e-16 ***
## speciesChinstrap    26.92     67.65    0.398  0.691
## speciesGentoo    1386.27     56.91   24.359 <2e-16 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Residual standard error: 460.8 on 330 degrees of freedom
## Multiple R-squared:  0.6745, Adjusted R-squared:  0.6725
## F-statistic: 341.9 on 2 and 330 DF, p-value: < 2.2e-16

#Reference Category: It is the Adelie penguin species, which if you take a look at r regression, following in
first alphabetically order, which this is automatically dropped from the row coefficients and absorbed directly
into the Intercept #Dummy Variables: What represents is the estimated mean body mass of the reference
group (Adelie penguins) and based on the data, the Adelie penguins have an average weight of 3,706.16g
#Regression Coefficient: The average weight difference between the remaining species and the reference group
is shown by the slopes: -Chinstrap penguins weigh 26.92g more on average than Adelie penguins -Gentoo
penguins weigh 1,386.44g more on average than Adelie penguins Gentoo penguins represents a massive,
highly significant weight increase #The relationship between the dummy-variable regression and the One-
Way ANOVA results: The exact overall fit statistics match the One-Way ANOVA table: -The F-statistic is
exactly 341.9 on 2 and 330 degrees of freedom -The p-value is exactly < 2.2 x 10-16 This concludes that

```

One-Way ANOVA and a Dummy-Variable Regression model are mathematically identical is proven

#Part E/5

```
# Fit the Two-Way ANOVA with interaction
twoway_model <- aov(body_mass_g ~ species * sex, data = penguins_clean)

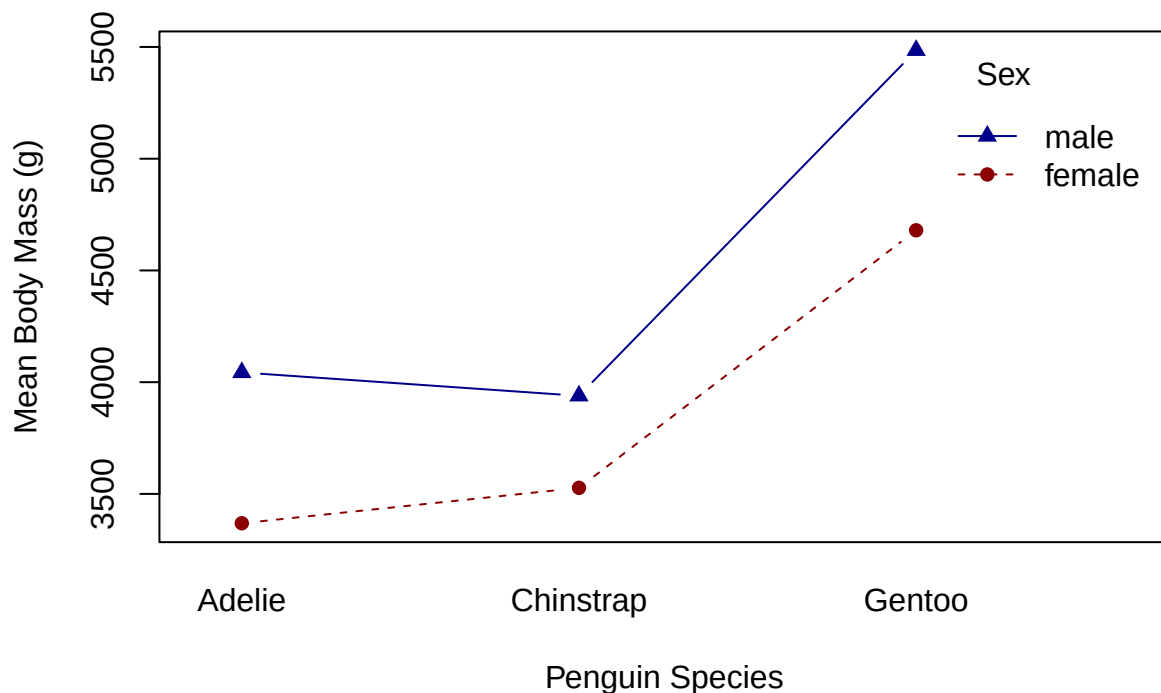
# Display the ANOVA table results
summary(twoway_model)
```

```
##           Df      Sum Sq Mean Sq F value    Pr(>F)
## species      2 145190219 72595110 758.358 < 2e-16 ***
## sex          1  37090262 37090262 387.460 < 2e-16 ***
## species:sex  2   1676557   838278   8.757 0.000197 ***
## Residuals   327  31302628   95727
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

#Statistical results #Main Effect of Species: $F(2,327)=758.36$, $p < 2 \times 10^{-16}$ The average body mass differs significantly across the three species #Main Effect of Sex: $F(1,327)=387.46$, $p < 10^{-16}$ There is a highly significant difference in average body mass between male and female penguins overall (with males being significantly heavier) #*Interaction Effect (Species $\times$ Sex): $F(2,327)=8.76$, $p=0.000197$ Since this is below $\alpha=0.05$, there is a significant interaction between species and sex and the effect of species on a penguin's body mass depends on its sex while also significantly depending different species

#Part F/6

```
# Generate the interaction plot using base R
interaction.plot(
  x.factor = penguins_clean$species,
  trace.factor = penguins_clean$sex,
  response = penguins_clean$body_mass_g,
  fun = mean,
  type = "b",
  col = c("darkred", "darkblue"),
  pch = c(16, 17),
  xlab = "Penguin Species",
  ylab = "Mean Body Mass (g)",
  trace.label = "Sex"
)
```



#Visual Observation: Looking the graph representing the mean body mass using the linear graph, males and females are plainly non-parallel #Interpretation of the Slopes: We already see that males are heavier than females, across three species, Adelie & Gentoo show a massive, steep vertical gap between males and females while Chinstrap shows a much smaller sex gap #Conclusion: Since the visual shows to lack of parallelism confirms the statistically significant interaction effect found from part E. It is now proven that the effect of a penguin's sex on its body mass is not constant and it depends heavily on the species being examined

#Part G/7

```
# Fit the full linear regression model with interaction
full_model <- lm(body_mass_g ~ species * sex, data = penguins_clean)

# Display the regression coefficients table, R-squared, and overall statistics
summary(full_model)
```

```
##
## Call:
## lm(formula = body_mass_g ~ species * sex, data = penguins_clean)
##
## Residuals:
```

	Min	1Q	Median	3Q	Max
	-827.21	-213.97	11.03	206.51	861.03

```
##
## Coefficients:
```

	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(> t)
(Intercept)	3368.84	36.21	93.030	< 2e-16 ***
speciesChinstrap	158.37	64.24	2.465	0.01420 *

```
## speciesGentoo          1310.91      54.42  24.088 < 2e-16 ***
## sexmale                674.66      51.21  13.174 < 2e-16 ***
## speciesChinstrap:sexmale -262.89     90.85  -2.894  0.00406 **
## speciesGentoo:sexmale    130.44     76.44   1.706  0.08886 .
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## Residual standard error: 309.4 on 327 degrees of freedom
## Multiple R-squared:  0.8546, Adjusted R-squared:  0.8524
## F-statistic: 384.3 on 5 and 327 DF,  p-value: < 2.2e-16
```

#Baseline Group: Adelie females are the omitted baseline group since R defaults to the first category alphabetically for both categorical variables #Intercept: What this represents is the estimated average body mass for an Adelie Female penguin which is approximately 3,368.8g #Main Effect Coefficients: This is reflected about the relative change to the baseline group when holding other baseline settings constant: - The “speciesChinstrap” represents the average weight difference between a Chinstrap Female and an Adelie Female -While the “speciesGentoo” represents the average weight difference between a Gentoo Female and an Adelie Female -And the “sexmale” represents the average weight difference between an Adelie Male and an Adelie Female and no other species to include here #Interaction Coefficients: The variables or coefficients has an interaction term with the “:” symbol, indicating two coefficients connected or interacted, what represents here is the additional adjustment to the male weight gap for that specific species compared to the baseline species gap, and the male weight premium is just not identical across species

###Let’s get back to the original research question... #“Does penguin body mass differ according to species and sex, and does the effect of species on body mass depend on sex?” #Statistical Evidence: The statistical evidence is the species effect, based on the data, Gentoo penguins are heavier on average than both Adelie and Chinstrap penguins and doesn’t matter with the sex comparison. Although Adelie and Chinstrap penguins have much closer average weights #Observed patterns: The observed pattern is the sex effect, observing within every single pieces, this shows that the male penguins are consistently heavier than the female penguins #Practical interpretation: The practical interpretation is the interaction effect, when comparing the weight gap between males and females, it is not uniform. Based on the data on why it is not uniform, this is because the male weight premium is largest among Gentoo penguins (~805g gap) and smallest among Chinstrap penguins (~412g gap), and this may apply to other research statistics similar to this # Based on the full linear regression model with interaction terms, this shows that it is approximately 81.4% of the total variance in penguin body mass